THE VENUE STREAMING

PLAYBOOK

How Smart Venues Are Turning Live Events
Into Global Experiences

✓ Reach audiences beyond your four walls

✓ Create new revenue streams from every event

✓ Build a global brand without a global budget

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01 The Live Streaming Opportunity

The live events industry has fundamentally changed. Audiences now expect a digital option — and the venues delivering it are winning.

The Numbers Tell the Story

Metric	Data Point
Global live streaming market	$100+ billion by 2027 (Grand View Research)
Viewers who prefer hybrid events	67% want the option to attend virtually (Eventbrite)
Revenue lift from adding virtual tickets	15-35% average increase per event
Fan willingness to pay for streams	72% of live music fans have paid for a stream (MIDiA Research)
Average virtual ticket price	$10-25 for concerts, $5-15 for other events

Every show you don't stream is an audience you're not reaching and revenue you're not earning.

Who's Already Doing This?

Forward-thinking venues across every category are streaming today:

- **Music venues** — selling virtual tickets alongside physical ones, reaching fans in other cities and countries
- **Theaters** — offering accessible viewing for patrons who can't attend in person
- **Houses of worship** — connecting with congregants who are homebound, traveling, or remote
- **Conference centers** — hybrid events are now the default expectation for corporate clients
- **Comedy clubs** — building national followings from local stages

02 5 Revenue Streams You're Missing

Streaming isn't just about exposure — it's a profit center. Here are five proven models:

1. Virtual Ticket Sales (Pay-Per-View) Sell access to your stream just like a physical ticket. Virtual tickets typically price at 30-50% of in-person tickets. A 500-capacity venue selling 200 virtual tickets at $15 each adds $3,000 per event with zero additional venue costs.	POTENTIAL **$3,000-15,000/event**
2. Subscriptions & Memberships Charge $10-25/month for access to all your streamed events. With 200 subscribers, that's $2,000-5,000/month in predictable recurring revenue — even during slow booking periods.	POTENTIAL **$2,000-5,000/month**
3. Tips & Donations Viewers send voluntary payments during streams. Music streams commonly generate $200-1,000+ per event in tips. Setup takes 10 minutes with tools like Streamlabs or Ko-fi.	POTENTIAL **$200-1,000/event**
4. Sponsorships Local businesses pay to have their brand on your stream — logo placement, branded segments, pre-roll ads. A single local sponsor can cover your entire streaming operation cost.	POTENTIAL **$500-5,000/month**
5. VOD & Content Licensing Your archived streams become a content library. License performances to artists, sell VOD replays, or generate YouTube ad revenue. Content works for you long after the show ends.	POTENTIAL **Ongoing passive income**

Combined, these revenue streams can add $50,000-200,000+ annually to your venue's bottom line.

03 What It Actually Takes

Venue streaming has gotten dramatically simpler and more affordable. Here's an honest breakdown of what's involved:

Equipment Essentials

Component	What It Does	Starting Cost
PTZ Cameras (2-3)	Remote-controlled cameras mounted in your venue — no operators needed	$1,600-6,000
Video Switcher	Cuts between camera angles in real time	$450-1,300
Audio Interface	Captures clean audio from your mixing board	$100-250
Streaming PC or Encoder	Compresses and sends video to the internet	$600-1,500
Cabling & Mounts	HDMI/SDI cables, ceiling mounts, adapters	$200-500

Internet Requirements

You need reliable upload speed — not download. Most venues need far less than they think:

Stream Quality	Upload Speed Needed	Typical Cost
720p (Good)	5-10 Mbps upload	Often included in existing business internet
1080p (Professional)	10-20 Mbps upload	$50-100/month for business fiber
4K (Premium)	25-50 Mbps upload	$100-200/month for dedicated fiber

Crew Requirements

Modern PTZ camera systems dramatically reduce crew needs:

Setup	Crew Size	Skill Level
2 PTZ cameras + auto-switching	0 (fully automated)	Initial setup only
2-3 PTZ cameras + live switching	1 person	Moderate (trainable in 1-2 sessions)
4-6 cameras + graphics	2-3 people	Experienced AV / trained staff
Full broadcast production	3-5 people	Professional crew

Total starting investment: $3,000-8,000
That's often recouped within 2-4 streamed events through virtual ticket sales alone.

04 The 3-Tier Approach: Start Small, Scale Smart

You don't need to build a broadcast studio on day one. The smartest venues follow a phased approach that proves ROI at each stage before investing more.

TIER 1: PROVE IT ($2,500-5,000)

- 2 PTZ cameras (wide shot + close-up)
- Blackmagic ATEM Mini Pro ($450)
- Audio feed from your existing FOH board
- Stream to YouTube + Facebook (free platforms)
- 1 person operates everything

Goal: Validate audience demand. Measure viewership and engagement for 4-6 events. This tier pays for itself if even 50 people buy a $10 virtual ticket.

TIER 2: MONETIZE ($8,000-15,000)

- 3-4 PTZ cameras with preset positions
- Dedicated streaming PC with vMix or OBS
- Professional audio interface + room microphones
- Ticketed streaming on Mandolin, Eventive, or Vimeo OTT
- Branded graphics, lower thirds, and overlays
- 1-2 person crew

Goal: Generate consistent revenue. Add virtual ticketing, sponsorship packages, and build a subscriber base. Target: $2,000-5,000/month in streaming revenue.

TIER 3: PROFESSIONALIZE ($20,000-50,000+)

- 5-6 cameras (PTZ + operated) with full coverage
- Broadcast-quality switcher with dedicated control panel
- Redundant internet with automatic failover
- ISO recording of all camera angles
- Dedicated stream audio mix with ambient mics
- Instant replay capability
- 2-4 person professional crew

Goal: Premium product commanding premium pricing. Virtual tickets at $20-50, corporate hybrid events at premium rates, national sponsorship deals.

05 Platform Strategy: Where to Stream

Different platforms serve different goals. Here's where to focus based on what you want to achieve:

Your Goal	Best Platform	Why
Maximum free reach	YouTube Live + Facebook Live	Largest audiences, free, permanent VOD archive
Sell virtual tickets	Mandolin / Eventive / Vimeo OTT	Built-in ticketing, access control, payment processing
Build a loyal community	Twitch or YouTube	Subscription models, chat culture, repeat viewership
Corporate / branded events	Vimeo Livestream	Ad-free, white-label, password protection
Cover all bases	Restream (multi-platform)	Stream to 30+ platforms from one feed simultaneously

Our recommendation: Start with YouTube + Facebook (free, maximum reach), then add a ticketed platform once you've validated demand.

06 Audio: The Make-or-Break Factor

Here's a truth most people learn the hard way: viewers will tolerate mediocre video for hours, but they'll leave within 30 seconds of bad audio.

The Right Way to Capture Audio

Method	Quality	Complexity	Best For
Camera microphone	Poor	Zero	Never use this for a real stream
Direct feed from FOH board	Good	Low	Quick and easy starting point
Dedicated stream mix (aux send)	Excellent	Moderate	Best balance of quality vs. effort
Full audio split + stream mixer	Broadcast	High	Large productions, ultimate control

The Secret Ingredient: Room Microphones

A direct board feed sounds like a studio recording — clean but lifeless. Adding 1-2 room microphones captures crowd energy, applause, and ambient atmosphere that makes viewers feel like they're actually there. This one addition transforms stream quality more than any camera upgrade.

We handle all of this for you — from the audio interface to the final mix that makes your stream sound broadcast-ready.

07 Legal Essentials You Need to Know

Music licensing for streaming is different from your standard venue performance license. Here's what you need to stay protected:

Quick Reference

Scenario	Risk Level	What You Need
Band plays original music	Low	Written permission from artist (in booking contract)
Band plays cover songs	Moderate	PRO streaming licenses (ASCAP, BMI, SESAC, GMR)
Recorded music during intermission	High	Royalty-free music library (Epidemic Sound, Artlist)
DJ set / all recorded music	Very High	Direct master licenses (complex) — avoid streaming unless cleared
Worship services	Low	CCLI Streaming License (~$100-500/year)

Essential Protections

- **Streaming clause in every booking contract** — get written permission from artists to stream their performance
- **PRO licenses for streaming** — your existing venue performance license likely doesn't cover online streaming
- **Venue signage** — "This event is being live streamed" posted at entrances
- **Royalty-free music** — for all non-live segments (pre-show, intermission, post-show)

We help our clients navigate all of this — from contract language to PRO registration to platform compliance.

08 Your Next Step

You've seen the opportunity. You know the numbers.
Now imagine this for your venue:

✓ Every event you host reaches 2x-10x more people

✓ A new revenue stream that grows with every show

✓ Artists choosing your venue because you offer streaming

✓ Corporate clients booking you because hybrid events are built in

✓ A growing content library that markets your venue 24/7

LET'S TALK ABOUT YOUR VENUE

We'll assess your space, recommend the right setup for your budget,
and show you exactly what your streaming revenue could look like.

FREE VENUE STREAMING ASSESSMENT

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What Happens When You Reach Out

- **1. Free consultation call** — we learn about your venue, events, and goals (30 min)
- **2. Custom streaming plan** — tailored equipment, platform, and monetization recommendations
- **3. Revenue projection** — realistic numbers based on your event schedule and audience
- **4. Pilot event** — we handle everything for your first stream so you can see it in action

No pressure. No obligation. Just a conversation about what's possible.